Chemical Spill and Sanitizer Handling Response

Purpose and Scope

This procedure describes how to respond to spills and leaks of sanitizers, cleaning chemicals, and lubricants at Riverbend Packaging, and how to handle sanitizer safely during normal use. The primary chemicals on site are a peracetic acid (PAA) sanitizer used for clean-in-place (CIP) of the filler and pump, a caustic cleaner, a quaternary ammonium floor sanitizer, and hydraulic oil for the press.

Chemical Hazard Summary

Chemical	Main hazards	Location	Neutralizer / absorbent
Peracetic acid sanitizer (15%)	Corrosive, oxidizer, respiratory irritant	CIP room	Dilute with water, absorb with inert pad
Caustic cleaner	Corrosive, burns skin and eyes	CIP room	Absorbent pad, then neutralize per SDS
Quat floor sanitizer	Irritant	Janitorial closet	Absorbent pad
Hydraulic oil	Slip hazard, skin irritant	Press bay	Oil-only absorbent

Safety Data Sheets are kept at each chemical station and in the EHS binder. Read the SDS before using any new product.

Safe Handling

1. Wear the PPE specified in the PPE Matrix: splash goggles, face shield for concentrate, 15 mil nitrile gloves, and chemical apron.
2. Add chemical to water, never water to concentrate.
3. Never mix sanitizer with caustic, bleach, or acids.
4. Keep containers closed and labeled. Transfer containers must carry a secondary label with name and hazard.
5. Use the eyewash station within 10 seconds of the work location. Test eyewash weekly.

WARNING: Mixing peracetic acid with caustic or chlorine products can release hazardous gas or heat. Never combine chemicals.

Spill Response

Step 1: Stop and Alert

1. Stop the source if it is safe to do so (close a valve, upright a container).
2. Alert nearby personnel and keep them away.
3. Identify the chemical from the label.

Step 2: Decide Small or Large

A **small spill** is under 1 gallon, a known chemical, no injuries, and no fire or vapor release you cannot control. A **large spill** is anything else, or any spill in which you are unsure of the chemical.

Step 3: Small Spill Cleanup

1. Put on PPE for the chemical.
2. Surround the spill with absorbent socks to prevent spread. Cover storm drains.
3. Apply absorbent pads working from the outside inward.
4. Place used absorbent in a labeled waste container.
5. Clean the surface with water and verify no residue or slip hazard remains.
6. Replace spill kit contents and notify the EHS Lead.

Step 4: Large Spill

1. Evacuate the area and call the emergency number.
2. Isolate the area and post a warning.
3. Do not attempt cleanup. Only the trained spill team responds to large spills.
4. Provide the SDS to responders.

Spills on or Near Equipment

If a chemical leaks from the RP-200 pump seal or any energized equipment, stop the equipment using the normal stop and lock out before cleanup if you must reach into guarded or powered areas. Do not wash down electrical enclosures. Product contact surfaces affected by a chemical release must be flagged for Quality, and potentially exposed product must be held.

First Aid

- **Eyes:** Flush at the eyewash for at least 15 minutes, holding the eyelids open. Seek medical attention.
- **Skin:** Remove contaminated clothing and rinse for at least 15 minutes.
- **Inhalation:** Move to fresh air and call for medical help if symptoms continue.
- **Ingestion:** Do not induce vomiting. Call poison control and provide the SDS.

Reporting

Every spill, regardless of size, must be reported on the incident form within the shift. The EHS Lead determines whether external reporting is required based on the quantity released. Quantities over the reportable threshold on the SDS require immediate notification.

Training

Employees who handle chemicals complete hazard communication training at hire and annually. The spill team practices a drill twice a year.